Charlie the Caterpillar

By Dom DeLuise

NARRATOR: One day, one bright sunny day, Charlie the Caterpillar was born. *(Charlie is born)* The world looked very, very big to Charlie because he was very, very small. Charlie soon found out how delicious green things tasted. *(Charlie nibbles on a blade of grass)* He could hear the wind whistling and the birds singing. *(Charlie smiles)* He was glad to be alive. Charlie decided to set out and see the world, so he looked to the left, and he looked to the right and then he went straight ahead. Soon Charlie saw two monkeys.

CHARLIE: Hi! What are you doing?

MONKEY 1: We're playing cards.

CHARLIE: Oh, that sounds like fun. Can I play too?

MONKEY 2: No, you can't.

CHARLIE: Why not?

MONKEY 1: Because you're an ugly caterpillar. Now get out of here.

4NG Fanatics

INTRODUCTION

Sticks and stones can break my bones, but words will never hurt me. – Well, the first part is true, but the second part is completely wrong.

When I was in grade school, I had to get glasses . . . then in middle school it was braces and the horrible transition of puberty when your bones grow too fast for you to NOT be clumsy and you get pimples and the braces make you lisp and you get food caught in your teeth that you don't even know is there and then Grandma Connie sends you the most hideous Christmas sweater, but you have to wear it because it was a gift . . . It happens to everyone, right? And no one, not one single person ever made fun of me . . . Is my nose growing yet? Just what I need!

In Charlie the Caterpillar, we experience the perils of growing up in a society that would rather make fun of you than to build you up.

Charlie the Caterpillar by Dom DeLuise.

MONKEY 1: *(echoing voice)* . . . Because you're an ugly caterpillar . . . .

NARRATOR: Charlie, for the very first time in his young life, felt bad. *(Charlie sighs heavily)* He would have shrugged his shoulders if he had any. He looked to the left, and he looked to the right and then he went

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

straight ahead. Pretty soon he saw two rabbits hopping around.

CHARLIE: Hi! What are you doing?

RABBIT 1: We're playing tennis.

CHARLIE: Oh, that looks like fun. Can I play too?

RABBIT 2: No, you can't.

CHARLIE: Why not?

RABBIT 1: Because you're an ugly caterpillar, and we don't play with ugly caterpillars. Now, get out of here.

NARRATOR: Now, for the second time in his young life, Charlie felt bad, very bad. His feelings were hurt.

CHARLIE: *(to himself)* What is ugly?

NARRATOR: He didn't feel ugly. He looked to the left, and he looked to the right and then he went straight ahead. Just then, Charlie saw two mice playing miniature golf.

CHARLIE: Hi! What are you doing?

MOUSE 1: We're playing golf.

CHARLIE: Oh, that really looks like fun. Can I play too?

MOUSE 2: No, you can't.

CHARLIE: Why not?

MOUSE 1: Because you're an ugly caterpillar, and we really don't play with ugly caterpillars. Now, get out of here.

4NG Fanatics

NARRATOR: Charlie, for the third time in his not-so-young life, felt very, very bad. In fact, Charlie started to feel ugly. No one wanted to play with him. So Charlie looked to the left, and he looked to the right and then he started to cry.

CHARLIE: *(crying)*

NARRATOR: Charlie wanted to be alone. He climbed up a tree and snuggled up to a small branch. *(Charlie climbs, he sits shivering)* He felt a little cold, so he went like this *(Charlie begins spinning a cocoon*) and he went like that, and he went like that, and he went like this, and he went like that, and before he knew it, he had spun himself a warm and wonderful cocoon.

CHARLIE: *(sadly)* Why can't I have a friend. *(exhausted, he drifts off to sleep)*

NARRATOR: All of a sudden, snow began to fall and cover everything with white. Winter had come, but Charlie was nice and warm in his comfortable cocoon. Charlie dreamed that he had a best friend, and in his dream they laughed and had fun together. *(Charlie laughs in his sleep)* After a while, the grass began to grow, the flowers began to bloom and the birds began to have a

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

party in the sky. Spring had come and somehow Charlie knew it was time to wake up. *(Charlie yawns and stretches)* And then -- oh, my goodness! *(Pop, pop – his wings unfurl one at a time; and Charlie is in awe, looking first left then right)* He had wings! Beautiful wings! Charlie had become a beautiful butterfly. *(Charlie flutters his wings and flies, laughing)* He flew up, up and up. He soared past the birds having a party in the sky. Charlie was flying high when he came upon the monkeys who were still playing cards.

MONKEY 2: *(begging)* Oh, please come and play with us!

CHARLIE: Why?

MONKEY 1: Because you're a beautiful butterfly.

CHARLIE: No, thanks. I gotta get outta here! *(He zooms away and the monkeys jump back, looking miserable)* Serves them right!

NARRATOR: He did a couple of loopy loops and then he came across the rabbits at their tennis game.

RABBIT 2: Oh, please, won't you come and play with us?

CHARLIE: Why?

RABBIT 1: Because you're such a beautiful butterfly!

4NG Fanatics

CHARLIE: Not on your life. Now I gotta get outta here! *(he flies off, leaving the rabbits looking very down-hearted)* Serves them right!

NARRATOR: He didn't want to play with them because they were quite mean to him when he was a caterpillar. He circled around for a while and then he saw the mice playing miniature golf.

MOUSE 2: *(pleading)* Please, please, pretty please, do come and play with us.

CHARLIE: Why?

MOUSE 1: Because you're really such a beautiful butterfly!

CHARLIE: Sorry, not today. I really have better things to do. Now I gotta get outta here! *(he soars off, leaving the mice looking pitiful)* Serves them right!

NARRATOR: They all wanted to be his friend because he was now a beautiful butterfly. They didn't know he was Charlie, the ugly caterpillar.

CHARLIE: If they want to be my friends just because of my beautiful wings, they can't be real friends.

NARRATOR: And just then Charlie heard someone crying. It was Katie the Caterpillar.

KATIE: *(crying with gusto)*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

CHARLIE: Why are you crying?

KATIE: Because no one will play with me. No one wants to be my friend because I'm an ugly caterpillar.

CHARLIE: *(winking and smiling)* I'll play with you. I'll be your friend.

KATIE: You will? Whoopeee!

NARRATOR: And then Charlie took Katie aside and told her all about becoming a butterfly. Charlie showed Katie what she will look like when she's a butterfly. *(they look in the surface of a small lake, Charlie standing behind her so that her reflection would show up like a mirror in the water)* And that made Katie feel good. From that day on, Charlie and Katie played cards and tennis and even miniature golf together. *(laughing)* They had a good time just like in Charlie's dream. Katie was happy and Charlie was very happy. He had finally found a friend . . . a real friend . . . a best friend.

4NG Fanatics

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Dom DeLuise
ISBN: 978-0671796075
Publisher: Aladdin
Date (Month/Year): April 1993

AWARD HISTORY

KS State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY